FOUNDATIONS OF INTERPERSONAL EFFECTIVENESS

By Group 6

Have you ever felt misunderstood even though you said what you thought was right?
Or maybe you meant well, but someone got upset after a conversation.

These moments remind us that **how we interact with others can make or break relationships.**
This is where **interpersonal effectiveness** becomes important.

What is Interpersonal Effectiveness?

Interpersonal Effectiveness

- Interpersonal Effectiveness refers to **your ability to interact with others** in a respectful, clear, and goal-oriented manner while maintaining healthy relationships.

- According to Neacsiu et al. (2018), this skill involves **balancing your needs, the needs of others, and the demands of the situation all at once.**

What is Effective Communication?

Effective Communication

- Effective communication is a toll you will need in your interpersonal relationships. This doesn't only mean speaking well; **it includes how you listen, what your body says (nonverbal cues), and when and where you choose to express your message.**

- According to Gamble and Gamble (2020), effective communication is **the process of sharing information in a way that is understood accurately and appropriately by both the sender and the receiver.** It includes verbal language (words and tone) and nonverbal elements (facial expressions, posture, gestures).

Why It matters at Home, in School, and in the Community.

Importance of Interpersonal skills

- You may not realize it, but **you're already using interpersonal skills every day** in ways that shape how others see you and how well you connect with them.

- Interpersonal effectiveness **helps you find the right words, the right tone, and the right attitude so your message comes across clearly without creating unnecessary tension.** It helps build trust in your family, especially as you're growing into more independence..

Interpersonal Challenges and How to Respond

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- Connecting with other people isn't always easy. You might be **misunderstood, ignored, criticized, or caught in awkward situations** that make you feel frustrated or shut down. These are what we call **interpersonal challenges** and everyone deals with them.

- Maybe you've had a classmates talk over you during group task. Or a friend misread your text message and thought you were being rude, even if you didn't mean it that way. These moments can be confusing and emotionally draining. **So how should you respond?**

Stay calm

When emotions run high, it's easy to snap, or say things you dont mean. But interpersonal effectiveness means **finding ways to repond and not just react to a situation.**

Learn how to manage your emtotions and communicate in a way that respects both your needs and the other person’s feelings

Active Listening

Paying attention, not just waiting for your turn to talk.

Somtimes the solution is as simple as asking questions like, **"Can you help me undderstand what you meant?"** Or saying **"I might have misunderstood, can we talk about it?"**

Small gestures as these can save relationships and **clear up confusion.**

Be assertive, not aggressive or passive.

Assertive means **expressing your thought and feeling honestly, but without putting others down.** It can be likened to saying, "I feel hurt when I'm not heard in the group". If you're upset with a friend, **don't go straight to social media to vent; talk to them directly.**

Effectice Communication: Verbal Communication

Verbal Communication

- Verbal communication **plays a central role in our daily interactions.** It's more than just speaking; it's also **how we express thoughts, ask questions, offer support, and resolve conflict**

- According to Beebe and Ivy (2028), verbal communication refers to **the process of using words to create and share meaning with others.**

Elements of Effective Verbal Communication

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To communicate effectively, you need to make sure your message follows the **seven important Cs of verbal communication.**

CLEAR

Your message should be **easy to understand,** with a specific goal in mind. **Avoid ambiguity and vague expressions.**

CONCISE

Say what you need to say **using the fewest possible words.** Leave out any **unnecessary details** that **might distract from your point.**

CONCRETE

Support your message with **solid facts or examples** to make it more **convincing and easier** to grasp.

CORRECT

Use **accurate grammar, appropriate language, and factual information.** Doing so builds your credibility and prevents confusion.

COHERENT

Your ideas should be **logically organized.** Each part of **your message should connect smoothly** to the next.

COMPLETE

Include all the **needed information** so your audience can take proper action or **fully understand your message.**

COURTEOUS

Use a **polite and respectful tone.** Show empathy and **avoid anything that could sound rude or dismissive.**

Communication Barriers and How to Overcome Them

Communication barriers make it **harder to understand each other.** Common examples include:

- **Noise or distractions** – Noise can break focus. Communicate in a quiet, distraction-free environment and ask for clarification if needed.

- **Language differences** – Unfamiliar words, regional slang, or speaking too fast can confuse listeners. Use simple words and check if the person understands.

- **Emotional interference** – Being upset, anxious, or angry can block understanding. Acknowledge feelings first and talk things through.

- **Assumptions and biases** – We may assume what the other person is going to say and stop listening. Be curious, ask questions, and be open to the other person's point of view.

Overcoming barriers involves: **self-awareness, adapting your message, and truly listening.**

Effective Communication: Nonverbal Communication

Nonverbal communication, as opposed to verbal communication, is a kind of language that **doesn't need words.** It includes:

- Body language
- Facial expressions
- Gestures
- Posture
- Eye contact
- Tone of voice
- Physical distance
- Silence

Nonverbal communication **can convey messages beyond words.**

In nonverbal communication, it is also important that we **understand body language, tone, and facial expressions:**

- **Body language** – Includes posture, movement, and gestures. It can show confidence, discomfort, defensiveness, or openness.
- **Tone of voice** – Shows how you say something and can affect the meaning of your words.
- **Facial expressions** – Can reveal emotions. Smiling may signal friendliness, while a raised eyebrow may show confusion or disbelief.

Along with that, it is also vital that we learn about **social cues and cultural sensitivity** in nonverbal communication:

- **Social cues** are **signals** people use **to communicate what they are feeling, thinking, or expecting.**
- They include body language, facial expressions, gestures, and silence.
- Reading social cues helps you know **when to speak, when to listen, and how to respond appropriately.**
- Social cues **can mean different things in different cultures.**
- **Cultural sensitivity** means being aware that **people from different backgrounds may interpret nonverbal behaviors differently.**
- It is important for **avoiding misunderstandings** and **showing respect and empathy.**

Another important thing to take note of in nonverbal communication is **practicing empathy and nonverbal listening.**

- **Empathy** is your **ability to feel or understand what another person is going through.**
- **Nonverbal listening** means **being fully present**—not just hearing words, but watching movements, facial expressions, and tone of voice.
- Being empathetic and paying attention to nonverbal cues **can help you understand when someone is not okay.**
- You can show that you care **through your presence, supportive expressions, and actions.**
- Listening with your eyes and heart, not just your ears, **helps build deeper trust with others.**

THANK YOU